FOR INHERITED AND AS-IS SELLERS, SOUTH SHORE MASSACHUSETTS

As-Is On-Market vs Cash Investor. *The Decision Sheet.*

The math most sellers never see before they sign at the kitchen table.

Before anyone hands you a number at the kitchen table, this is the framework I run for every inherited or as-is property on the South Shore. Two columns, real comps, real rehab assumptions, and the actual net you would keep at close.

WHAT THIS SHEET DOES

Lays the as-is cash offer and the as-is on market sale next to each other, with the same property, the same condition, and real Massachusetts closing math. By the end you will know what to ask, what to calculate, and which path actually fits your estate.

THE TWO PATHS

Same house. Two strategies. *Two very different nets.*

COLUMN A

The Cash Investor Offer

Fast, simple, low friction. The investor is pricing in repairs, risk, holding costs, and profit before they ever name a number.

- Offer price
- Estimated after repair value the investor is using
- Estimated rehab budget the investor is using
- Investor target margin, usually 12 to 18 percent
- Your actual net at close
- Speed, typically 14 to 21 days
- Contingencies, usually none
- Showings, none

COLUMN B

As-Is, On Market, With a Real Comp Packet

Still sold as-is, but exposed to the open market with documentation, pricing strategy, and informed buyer competition. More coordination, often a stronger seller net.

- Realistic as-is list price based on comps
- Estimated days on market for as-is properties in the area
- Buyer pool, owner occupants, FHA flexible, 203k buyers, local investors
- Concessions you may negotiate
- Commission and closing costs
- Your actual net at close
- Showings, managed inside a 10 to 14 day window

WHY THE SPREAD EXISTS

One math problem, *two very different answers.*

Most off-market cash offers are built from a formula, not from what the home is worth today. The investor starts with what they believe the home could sell for after repairs, subtracts their rehab budget, subtracts holding and closing costs, then builds in their profit margin. The number that lands at the kitchen table is what is left after all of that.

An as-is on market sale works the opposite way. Instead of one buyer pricing in every risk for themselves, multiple buyers compete with the same comps, the same condition report, and the same documentation in front of them. That competition tends to pull the seller's net higher, even when the home still needs real work.

> WHY CASH OFFERS COME IN LOW
>
> After Repair Value, minus rehab budget, minus carrying costs, minus closing costs, minus investor profit margin, equals your cash offer. Every line on the right side of that equation belongs to the investor. Until you have your own comps and your own quotes, there is no way to tell how generous or how aggressive each one is.

ONE QUINCY HOUSE, TWO OUTCOMES

The 1972 split entry, *real numbers.*

A family inherited a 1972 split entry in Quincy after their father passed. A cash investor sat at the kitchen table and offered $475,000. Three friends and a neighbor told them to take it. Fast, clean, the house needed work.

We listed it as-is with a mechanical history binder, four contractor quotes, and a fourteen sale comp packet, so every buyer walked in already informed. The property sold in 23 days at $545,000.

CASH OFFER	SOLD PRICE	DAYS ON MARKET	SELLER NET DELTA*
$475,000	$545,000	23	*+$37,000*

THE MINI NET SHEET

The math behind the headline.

LINE ITEM	CASH INVESTOR PATH	AS-IS ON MARKET PATH
Gross sale price	$475,000	$545,000
Commission (5 percent)	$0	($27,250)
MA stamp tax ($4.56 per $1,000)	$0 (buyer)	($2,485)
Attorney, recording, closing items	($1,500)	($1,500)
Buyer credits or concessions	$0	($2,500) conservative
Estimated seller net	$473,500	*$511,265*

Net difference, approximately $37,000 more in the seller's pocket. The cash offer wins on speed. The as-is on market path wins on net.

**Numbers are illustrative and do not include taxes. Talk to your CPA about capital gains or estate tax considerations specific to your situation.*

WHERE SELLERS LEAVE MONEY ON THE TABLE

Five places sellers *quietly give up leverage.*

01 Accepting a number before seeing retail as-is comps for the area.

02 Confusing "no repairs" with "no preparation."

03 Letting one investor define the rehab budget without a second contractor opinion.

04 Looking at offer price instead of net proceeds after fees, credits, and closing costs.

05 Assuming an inherited house will not qualify for a strong buyer pool when sold as-is.

WHAT A REAL COMP PACKET INCLUDES

More than *three nearby sales.*

- Recent sold comps for both as-is and renovated houses in the same submarket
- Active competition the buyer pool is comparing you against right now
- Pending sale data when available, to read where the market is moving
- Repair-sensitive pricing tiers, what the same house would list for in different conditions
- Contractor input on the actual scope of work and a realistic budget
- Market time expectations for as-is properties in the area
- A realistic estimate of seller net under more than one pricing scenario

PREPARATION WITHOUT RENOVATION

Selling as-is does not mean *selling blind.*

Selling as-is does not mean doing nothing. It means choosing the preparation that protects value without over-improving the property. For inherited and estate homes, this is where most of the seller leverage actually lives.

- Full cleanout and removal of personal contents
- Smoke and carbon monoxide compliance
- Safety fixes that buyers and inspectors will flag immediately
- Basic landscaping and curb appeal that costs little and changes the first impression
- Professional photography that does the house justice on MLS and listing portals
- A mechanical history binder that documents the age of the roof, heating, electrical, and plumbing
- Transparent repair documentation so every buyer is making a fair offer on the same information

CHOOSING THE RIGHT PATH

When each path is *the better fit.*

Neither path wins every time. The right call depends on the estate, the building, the family, and the calendar. Here is how to read the situation honestly.

A cash investor offer may be *the better fit when:*

- The estate needs immediate liquidity.
- The property condition creates severe financing limitations.
- The family values speed and certainty more than maximum net.
- There are title, occupancy, or cleanout issues that make open market timing difficult right now.

An as-is on market sale may be *the better fit when:*

- The family wants to test true market demand before discounting heavily.
- The house needs work but is still financeable or attractive to multiple buyer types.
- There is enough time to prepare documentation and market the property correctly.
- Maximizing estate proceeds is a top priority.

FOR PROBATE AND ESTATE SELLERS

In probate and estate sales, the goal is not just a fast sale. It is making a decision that can be explained, documented, and defended as reasonable for the estate and the family.

BEFORE YOU SAY YES

Six questions to ask *before you sign a cash offer.*

01 What after repair value are you using, and what comps support it?

02 What is your rehab budget for this property?

03 What margin are you building in for yourself?

04 What would my net be if I listed as-is with a real comp packet?

05 What is your walk away timeline if I take this to market first?

06 What buyer pool am I giving up by not going to market first?

You are allowed to ask. You are allowed to run both sets of numbers.
A serious investor will usually still be interested after you compare both paths.

READY WHEN YOU ARE

Want me to run this math *on your property?*

Book a free 30 minute strategy call. We will build both columns on your specific property, the cash number and the on market number, with real comps and real rehab assumptions.

Book a strategy call or *DM STRATEGY on Instagram @kristareckerproperties*

Krista Recker

Krista Recker Properties, VIP Group
South Shore Massachusetts, Probate and Estate Sales Specialist
krista@moorrealty.com